

Markscheme

Mathematics: analysis and approaches

Practice question bank

17. (a)

Consider the function $f(x) = \frac{2x + 10}{(x - 3)(x + 1)}$.

Write $f(x)$ as the sum of partial fractions in the form $\frac{A}{x - 3} + \frac{B}{x + 1}$.

$$2x + 10 = A(x + 1) + B(x - 3) \quad (M1)$$

$$\text{substituting } x = 3: 16 = 4A \Rightarrow A = 4 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

$$\text{substituting } x = -1: 8 = -4B \Rightarrow B = -2 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

[3 marks]